Tamilini, a school student of Class VI, visited a Science Centre accompanied by her grandmother. There they saw a time machine. The operator of the time machine explained the working of the machine.

Operator: If you press different buttons in the machine, it would take you to the chosen period of time. Why don't you enjoy the experience of watching different periods of time using this machine?

(After listening to the operator, both Tamilini and her grandmother were excited and decided to have the experience of the time machine.)

Tamilini: Can we go forward and see how 2200 AD(CE) would be, grandma?

Grandma: What is so interesting about our future in 2200 AD(CE), Tamil? Let's go backward and see how our past was like.



The story of human evolution can be scientifically studied with the help of archaeology and anthropology.

Tamilini: You sound right, grandma.

Grandma pushed the button to 1950 AD(CE). They saw mostly people walking, a few riding bicycles and buses appearing rarely on the roads. Slowly they moved back to 1850. There were no buses or cycles. Carts pulled by mules and bullocks were seen on the roads. Horse-drawn cart was a rare occurrence.

Tamilini then turned the button to 8,000 years back. People were engaged in raising crops and livestock. She pushed the button to get a picture of life 18,000 years ago. She saw the humans living in caves. They were using tools made of stones and bones for hunting. Tamilini was frightened by the hunting scene and pushed the button forward to return to the present.

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Grandma: Are you afraid, Tamil?

Grandma urged Tamilini to go further backward to see the ancient humans who lived with the apes. But Tamilini was not inclined. So both of them left the spot.

Tamilini: Grandma, will you tell me the story of evolution of humans?

Grandma: Yes, certainly.

Grandma: Anthropologists have unearthed the footprints of humans in a country called Tanzania, which is in eastern Africa. They were found in rock beds submerged under the sand.

Info Bits

Archaeology is the study of pre historic humans remained materials used by pre historic humans. Excavated material remains are the main source for archaeological studies.

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